

Integrating Zeek with ELK Stack

Zeek is an open source network security monitoring tool. This article discusses how to integrate Zeek with ELK.

In the article titled ‘Network Security Monitoring Made Easy with Zeek’ published in the March 2022 edition of this magazine, we looked into the capabilities of Zeek and learned how to get started with it. We will now take our learning experience a bit further and see how to integrate it with ELK (also known as Elasticsearch, Kibana, Beats, and Logstash).

For this, we will use a tool called Filebeat, which monitors, collects and forwards the logs to Elasticsearch. We will configure Filebeat with Zeek, so that the data collected by the latter will be forwarded and centralised in our Kibana dashboard.

Installing Filebeat

Let’s first set up Filebeat with Zeek. To install Filebeat using *apt*, give the

following command:

```
sudo apt install filebeat
```

```
# Configuration file.
# ===== Filebeat inputs =====
filebeat.inputs:
# Each - is an input. Most options can be set at the input level, so
# you can use different inputs for various configurations.
# Below are the input specific configurations.
# filestream is an input for collecting log messages from files.
- type: log
# Change to true to enable this input configuration.
enabled: true
# Paths that should be crawled and fetched. Glob based paths.
paths:
  - /var/log/*.log
  - /opt/zeek/logs/current/*.log
  #- c:\programdata\elasticsearch\logs\*
# Exclude lines. A list of regular expressions to match. It drops the lines that are
# matching any regular expression from the list.
#exclude_lines: ['^DBG']
```

Figure 1: Filebeat config (a)